Claim Denials and Appeals Guide

Synthetic training document for an educational RAG project. This is not an official Aetna policy or plan document.

Common Denial Categories

Claims may be denied because of inactive coverage, missing or invalid information, duplicate submission, non-covered service, missing prior authorization, coding mismatch, benefit exhaustion, untimely filing, or provider eligibility issues.

Denial Review

A claims operations user may review denial codes, claim history, eligibility, authorization records, provider status, and supporting documentation to determine the likely root cause.

Appeals

A member or provider may appeal a coverage or payment decision. Supporting information can include medical records, claim details, authorization evidence, and other documents relevant to the disputed decision.

Human Review

Clinical judgment, ambiguous documentation, or high financial impact may require escalation to a human reviewer rather than an automated action.

Denial Code Reference

Code	Category	Example Reason	Suggested Next Step
D01	Eligibility	Coverage inactive on service date	Verify member eligibility
D02	Authorization	Required PA not found	Check authorization record
D03	Duplicate	Matching claim already processed	Review prior claim
D04	Coding	Coding did not meet claim edit	Validate procedure/diagnosis
D05	Benefit	Service not covered	Review benefit terms